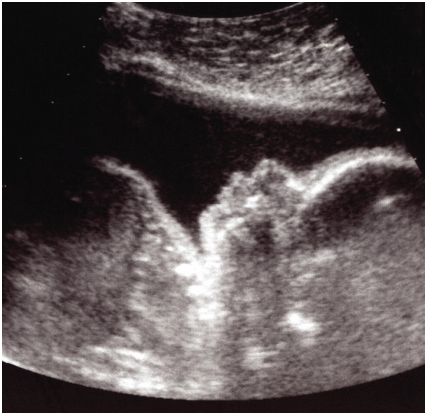




YOU ARE **25 WEEKS AND 1 DAY**

104 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Here the baby is looking directly upward. The profile is nicely detailed with the nose, lips, and chin clearly outlined. The neck is still quite short so, as this image shows, the head is still held quite close to the chest.

“Your prenatal classes will give you a chance to learn about labor, birth, and life with a newborn, and make new friends.”

If you arranged them earlier in your pregnancy, you may be starting [prenatal classes](#) also called childbirth education classes. The Lamaze Method and The Bradley Method are common classes. Ask your health-care provider, friends, and staff at the hospital where you're giving birth about classes near you. In the class, you may be taught, for example, relaxation or breathing techniques, or be told about the different types of pain relief available. You'll also be given advice on topics where you'll learn all the basics: How to diaper, dress, feed, carry, and generally take care of your baby when you bring them home from the hospital. It's common to feel excited about the classes and eager to learn about what's going to happen. But prenatal classes are not just about gathering information; they're also about meeting others, which is difficult for some people. You'll likely find a lot of common ground with your classmates. Just talking about your symptoms or worries can help. It can be reassuring to know that you're not the only person to feel a certain way.

If you do make friends in your prenatal class, this support group can also be very helpful after you all have your babies.

VAGINAL INFECTIONS

I think I have a vaginal infection. Will this harm my baby? It is unlikely to harm your baby since the mucus plug around the cervix stops infection from reaching them. The symptoms of an infection—itching, irritation, and a discharge with an unpleasant odor—are uncomfortable. Your doctor will test for an infection by taking a swab from your vagina and will prescribe medication if necessary.

RIB PAIN

As the uterus expands, the rib cage is pushed outward to make room for it, and this can lead to rib pain or discomfort. It is more likely if you have a smaller than average body frame or in a multiple pregnancy. It can be made worse if your baby kicks a lot or spends a lot of time in the breech position since her head will push against your diaphragm and rib cage.